

BATTLEFIELD

2042

OVERAMBITIOUS



We'd gotten so used to yearly iterations of Battlefield that it completely escaped our minds that it had

been 3 whole years since Battlefield V released. One might think that after cooking for 3 years Battlefield 2042 would be DICE's return to form, a revival for the franchise and all that good stuff, but unfortunately Battlefield 2042 is far from it.

Story

The decision to skip on the single-player campaign and focus completely on the multiplayer aspect would have gone down fine with fans if the game wasn't such a mess. It's the multiplayer that everyone buys the game, so the fact that they decided to double down on that and go all-in was brave, and understandable. Unfortunately, we don't think it paid off.

Gameplay

When it comes to the gameplay mechanics, it's the same game you've been playing for years. They've got a quick tutorial once you start the game

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for the first time, and after that you're free to dive into any of the game's available modes.

All-Out Warfare

The game mode that defines the Battlefield franchise, All-Out Warfare is the large-scale battle mode, where two sides of 64, instead of the usual 32, are pitted against each other in a quest to conquer and hold the majority of the map. DICE's aim here was to make Battlefield 2042 the biggest Battlefield ever by bumping up the player count and scaling up the maps.

To accommodate the extra players, DICE has scaled the maps up to ridiculous proportions. As a result, we have to deal with large amounts of empty space, with so many maps having swathes of barren wasteland which don't see much action. The only places that see any action are the capture points. To compensate for the amount of travelling players need to do, you

can now call-in a variety of vehicles for free, or even spawn in existing friendly vehicles on the map. Being able to choose where you spawn does make it easier to play along with friends, as opposed to them spawning on the opposite end of the map. That still does little to reduce the amount of time you will spend running between points when you don't have a vehicle drop-in available, or if your spawn point is too far away from where you need to go.

In terms of overall experience, the increase in the number of players isn't really noticeable.

The scale of the map and the amount of time it takes to get from point A to point B is noticeable though. On the rare occasion you do see north of 64 players rushing a contested warzone, it's just chaos. One might argue that bullets flying everywhere with no clue who or what is shooting at you is Battlefield's MO, but scaling the number of people up just makes things more frustrating, not fun. It doesn't help that the game was a buggy mess on launch, which only adds to the frustration.